IT Help Desk Knowledge Base

CSN IT Help Desk

100 pts
/ 100 points

Unit 2 — Word Processing · Project 5 (Core)

How to use this instruction sheet: Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Word 365, and keep this sheet open beside it. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, and where to find the tool — but you must figure out the exact steps yourself. That's the learning.

Screen Recording Requirement

To verify your own work, record yourself completing 3 tasks while working on this project.

- Use Xbox Game Bar (press Win+G) or Loom (loom.com — free account) to record your screen
- Show yourself completing any 3 tasks from the list below
- Submit the recording to Canvas along with your completed file

D1 — Manage Documents

18 points (3 tasks)

5 Task 1 — Apply a light blue page color to the entire document

WHY THIS MATTERS

Page color in Word is a document-wide setting, not something that can be limited to a single page — applying it gives the whole document a distinct, branded look at a glance.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Page Color → choose a light blue swatch (or More Colors for a custom shade).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page in the document shows the same light blue tint behind the text.

5 Task 2 — Add a box border around the entire document

WHY THIS MATTERS

A page border gives a document a finished, professional look and is common on cover pages, certificates, and formal reports.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Page Borders → Box setting → choose a line style and width → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page shows a border drawn around the outer edge of the page margins.

8 Task 3 — Insert a hyperlink to the CSN IT Help Desk support portal

WHY THIS MATTERS

Hyperlinks let readers click straight through to more detailed documentation instead of needing it all on the page.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the text that should become the link → Insert tab → Links group → Link → type or paste the destination URL → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The selected text turns blue and underlined, and Ctrl+clicking it opens the destination URL.

D2 — Insert & Format Text, Paragraphs, and Sections

22 points (3 tasks)

5 Task 4 — Insert a degree symbol (°) in the Fahrenheit troubleshooting note

WHY THIS MATTERS

Special characters like ° aren't on a standard keyboard, but Word can insert them as a real character so the text reads correctly.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Place your cursor where the symbol should go → Insert tab → Symbols group → Symbol → More Symbols → find ° (U+00B0) → Insert.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A real ° character appears in the text, not the word "degrees" typed out.

8 Task 5 — Insert a column break in the two-column FAQ section

WHY THIS MATTERS

A column break forces text in a multi-column layout to jump to the top of the next column at a specific point, instead of just flowing naturally — useful for keeping a question and its answer together.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click right before the text that should start the new column → Layout tab → Page Setup group → Breaks → Column.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The text after your cursor jumps to the top of the next column, leaving the rest of the current column blank below it.

9 Task 6 — Change the FAQ section's page setup to 0.75-inch margins

WHY THIS MATTERS

Different sections of a long document sometimes need different page setups — a two-column FAQ section often needs tighter margins than the rest of the report to fit comfortably.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click inside the FAQ section (it must already be its own section, separated by a section break) → Layout tab → Page Setup group → Margins → Custom Margins → set all four margins to 0.75" → make sure "Apply to" is set to "This Section".

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Only the FAQ section's margins change; the rest of the document keeps its original margins.

D3 — Manage Tables and Lists

52 points (7 tasks)

9 Task 7 — Convert the tab-separated ticket priority list to a table

WHY THIS MATTERS

Tabular data is much easier to scan and compare when it's in a real table with aligned columns and borders, rather than plain tab-separated text.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the tab-separated lines → Insert tab → Tables group → Table → Convert Text to Table → confirm the number of columns Word detects → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The plain text becomes a real table with visible borders, separate cells, and aligned columns.

8 Task 8 — Convert the outdated software version table back to plain text

WHY THIS MATTERS

Sometimes a table is overkill for simple information — converting it back to plain text can make a short list read more naturally as a paragraph.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click anywhere inside the table → Table Design or Layout tab → Data group → Convert to Text → choose a separator (Tabs is typical) → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The table's borders and cell structure disappear, replaced by plain text with your chosen separator between items.

5 Task 9 — Increase cell margins on the equipment table for readability

WHY THIS MATTERS

Cell margins control the padding between a cell's border and its text — increasing them gives cramped table text some breathing room.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click inside the table → Table Layout tab → Alignment group → Cell Margins → increase the Top, Bottom, Left, and Right values → OK.

HOW YOU'LL IT WORKED

There's visibly more white space between the text in each cell and the cell's border lines.

8 Task 10 — Split the merged header cell in the ticket table into two columns

WHY THIS MATTERS

A merged cell that spans multiple columns can later need to become separate cells again — for example, if you decide a single "header" label should really be two distinct column headers.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click inside the merged cell → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Split Cells → set Number of Columns to 2 → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The single wide cell becomes two separate cells side by side, each independently editable.

5 Task 11 — Resize the equipment table columns to fit content

WHY THIS MATTERS

Default column widths are rarely ideal — resizing columns to match their actual content makes a table look intentional rather than auto-generated.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click inside the table → Table Layout tab → Cell Size group → AutoFit → AutoFit Contents (or manually drag a column border to resize it).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Column widths visibly change to snugly fit the longest entry in each column, instead of being evenly or arbitrarily sized.

9 Task 12 — Split the long software inventory table into two separate tables

WHY THIS MATTERS

A very long table can be easier to manage as two separate, clearly labeled tables instead of one continuous block — for example, splitting "Operating Systems" from "Applications."

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the row that should become the FIRST row of the new second table → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Split Table.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

What was one table becomes two separate tables with a paragraph break between them, each keeping its own header row if you add one.

8 Task 13 — Apply a custom bullet character (checkmark) to the quick-fix list

WHY THIS MATTERS

The default round bullet point is generic — a custom symbol like a checkmark visually reinforces that each item is an action a reader can check off.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the list → Home tab → Paragraph group → Bullets dropdown arrow → Define New Bullet → Symbol → choose Wingdings as the font → select a checkmark character → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every bullet in the list is replaced by the checkmark symbol instead of the default round dot.

D5 — Insert and Format Graphic Elements

8 points (1 task)

8 Task 14 — Insert a rounded rectangle shape to highlight the emergency contact box

WHY THIS MATTERS

A shape with a fill color and border draws the reader's eye to important information, like emergency contact details, far more effectively than plain text.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → Shapes → choose Rounded Rectangle under Basic Shapes → click and drag to draw it over or near the emergency contact text → right-click the shape → Add Text → type the contact information.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A colored, rounded-corner box appears on the page containing the emergency contact text, visually separated from the surrounding paragraphs.